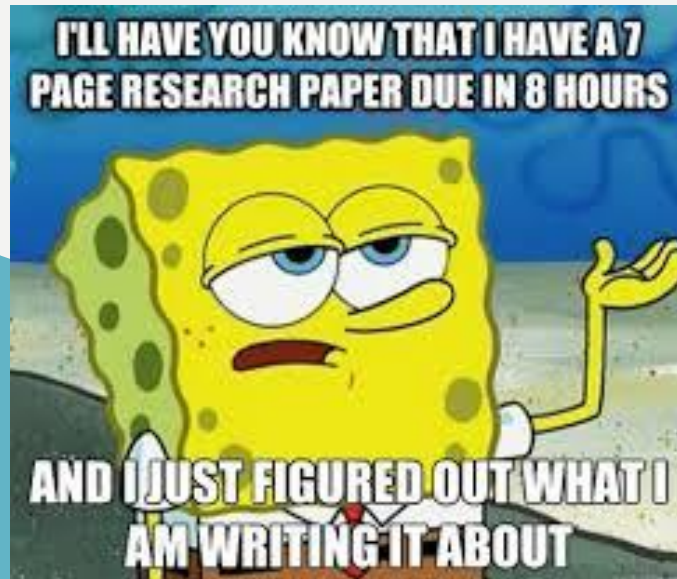


WRITING WORKSHOP: STS PROJECT TOPIC SELECTION



AGENDA

- Prospectus Critique Assignment debrief
- What is the Prospectus?
- How do we scaffold the Prospectus process?
- How do I get started?
- Topic Statement for your STS Project (Research Paper)
 - Where to start?
 - What are some considerations when picking your topic?
 - Citations?
 - Process?
 - Questions?

MEET WE CAN BUT



AN AGENDA IS A MUST

PROSPECTUS CRITIQUE DEBRIEF

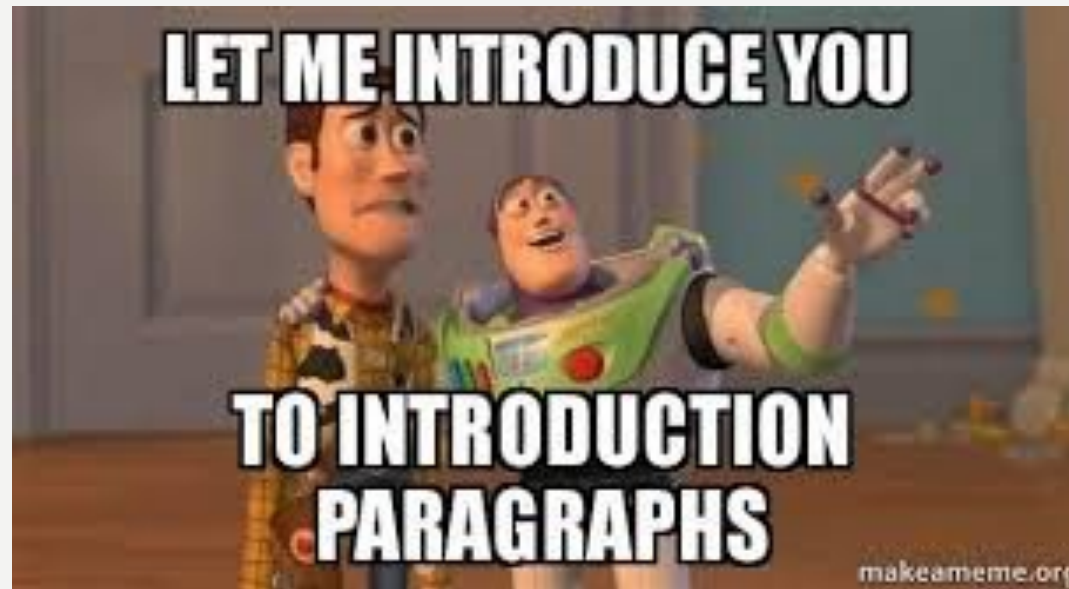
- Based on the Prospectus you read...
 - What makes a successful Prospectus?
 - What should we avoid that would make our Prospectus less than successful?
- In preparation for writing your own Prospectus...
 - What skills do *you* want to develop through your own project?
 - What challenges do you anticipate with this work?
 - How can we address these challenges?

PROSPECTUS

- Title Page (see template on Canvas)
- Introduction – Gives the reader an indication of your general topic and that there are two projects in this research proposal
- Capstone Project – Detailed summary of your capstone project
- STS Project – What is your topic and how do you plan to support this analysis with STS concepts/theories/frameworks?
- Conclusion – Reiterate Capstone deliverable and STS deliverable – what do you hope to find from each project?
- References – APA formatting

INTRODUCTION

- Attention grabbing opening sentence
- General introduction to the topic(s) of your projects
- 1-2 sentences describing your Capstone project
- 1-2 sentences describing your STS project



CAPSTONE PROJECT DESCRIPTION

- Double check with your capstone advisor in case they have specific requirements for this section
- In general, this section is meant to give a comprehensive overview of your capstone project
- If you are not in a capstone experience until next semester Professor Seabrook has instructions for you



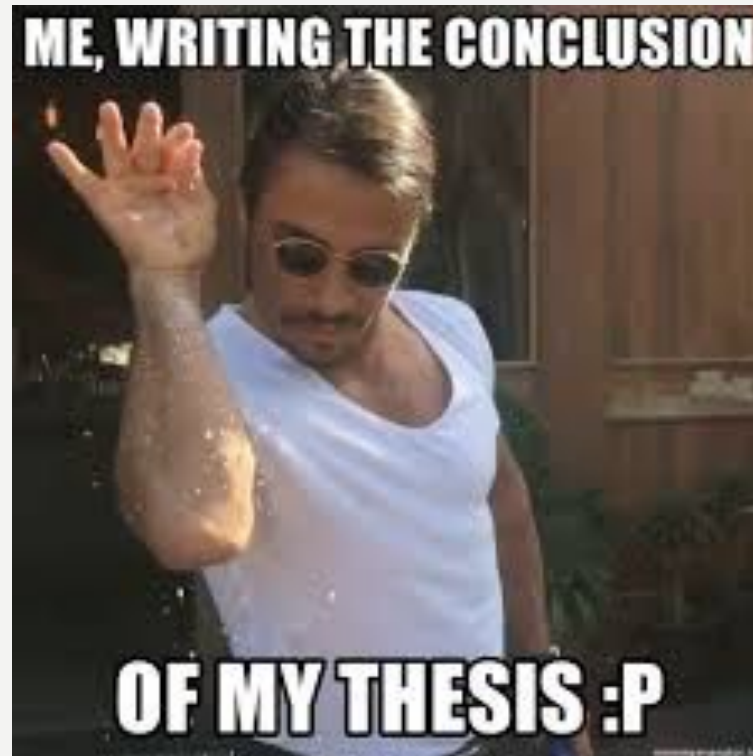
STS PROJECT DESCRIPTION

- 2-3 main paragraphs
- One paragraph detailing the background of your topic (What is it? Why is it important?)
- One paragraph describing the research methods you will use to gather and organize sources (What keywords will you use? Will you organize your research by topic, date, alphabetically, etc.?)
- One paragraph detailing your STS literature review (What is it? What are the critiques of it? How will you use this framework to answer your topic?)



CONCLUSION

- Reiterate your technical deliverable and STS deliverable. What do you anticipate the outcome of both projects to be? (Answer this question separately)

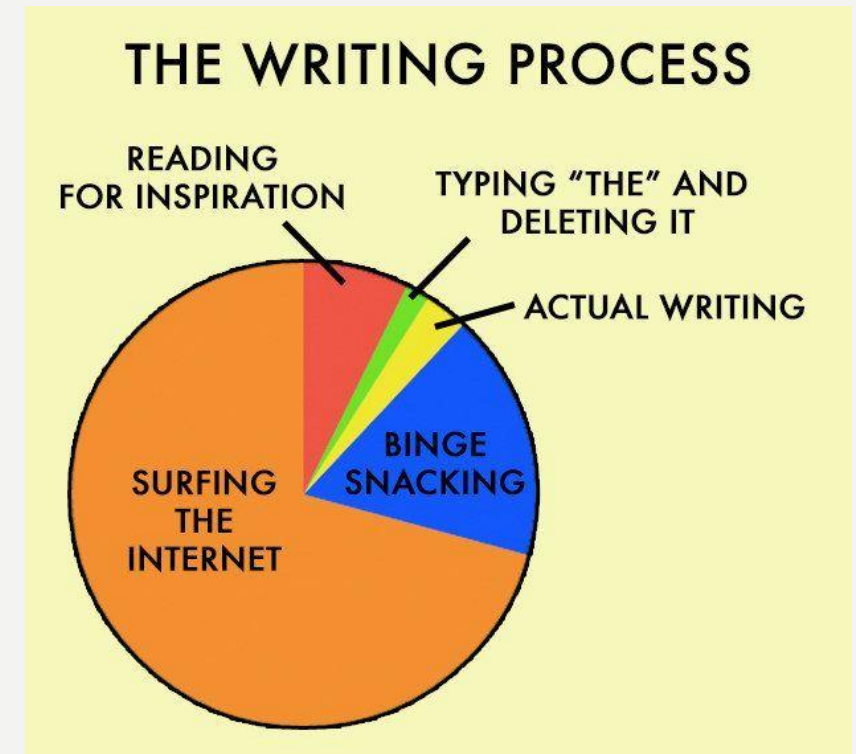


PROSPECTUS

- Title Page (see template on Canvas)
- Introduction – Gives the reader an indication of your general topic and that there are two projects in this research proposal
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HOW DO WE SCAFFOLD THE PROSPECTUS?

- Prospectus and related assignments = 50% of your course grade
- Prospectus Critique
- Topic Statement
- One-on-One Meeting(s) w/ Prof.
- Annotated Bibliography
- Prospectus Drafts
- Peer Editing Workshops
- Final Prospectus

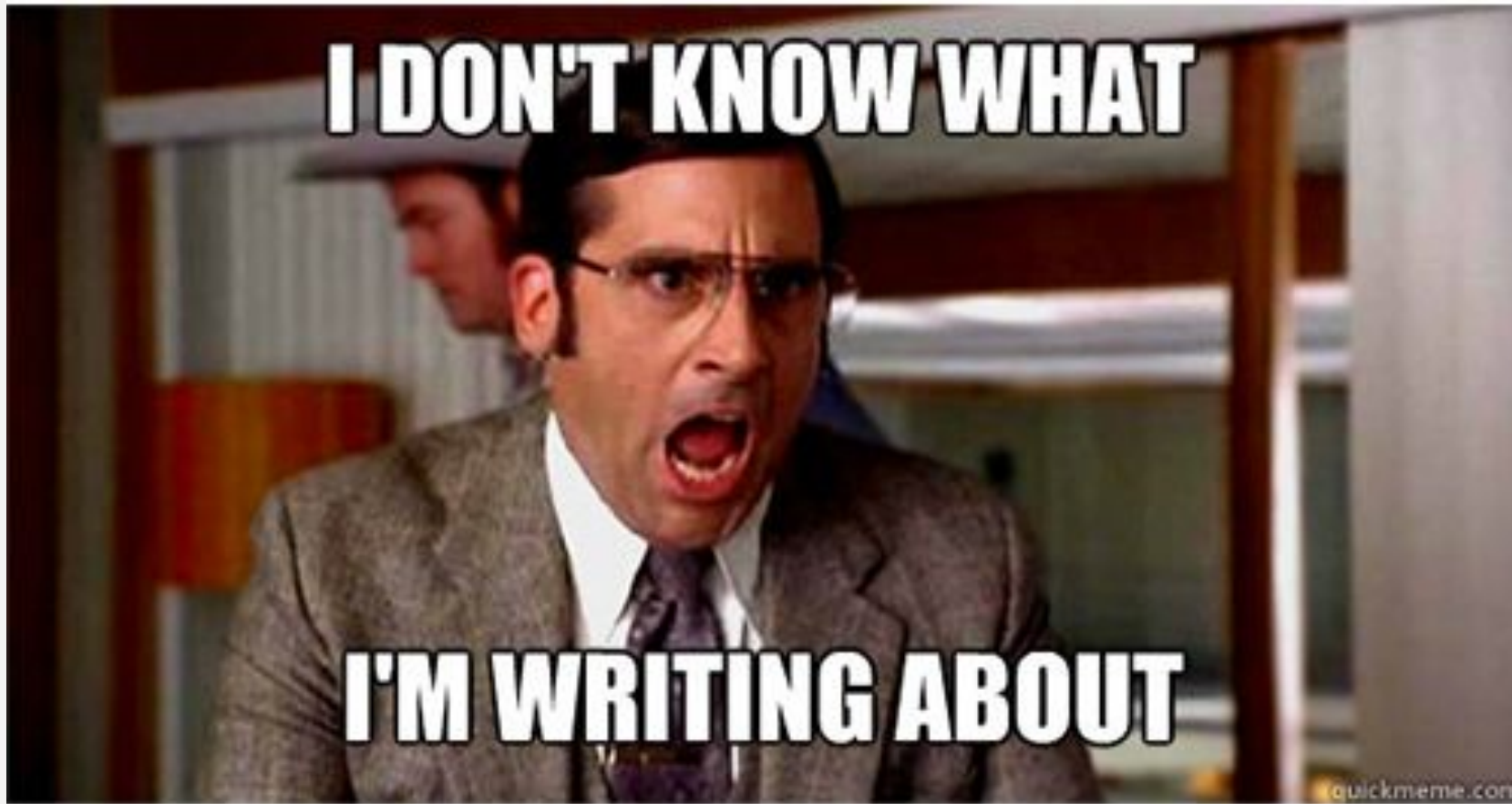


HOW DO I GET STARTED?

- What do you want to explore for your STS project?
 - What is your motivation for studying this topic?
 - What do you hope to gain from this project?



TOPIC STATEMENT ASSIGNMENT



WHERE TO START?

- Choose a topic that you are interested in!
- Narrow your topic to something manageable (can you write about it in 12-15 pages?)
- Talk about your research ideas with a friend (or your professor)



CHOOSE A TOPIC YOU ARE INTERESTED IN!

- Your Capstone project is NOT included in your STS Project
- You do write about both projects in the Prospectus (research proposal) - your projects can be closely related, or they can have a loose theme that connects them - you get to decide!
- If you don't know where to start: Start with your capstone project and pick an aspect of it that you are interested in learning more about!
- The audience for your STS Research Paper is Undergraduate Students at UVA



EXAMPLE

- Capstone Project: A technical project relating to biodiversity
- STS Research Paper: Something about biodiversity!
 - Question: *How* do Genetically Modified Organisms (GMOs) threaten biodiversity?



BREAK IT DOWN!

- *How do GMOs threaten biodiversity?*
 - How do you define GMOs?
 - What does the label GMO apply to?
 - Does anyone oversee/regulation GMOs?
 - How do you define biodiversity?
 - Has there ever been a case of GMOs harming biodiversity?
 - What is the current possible risk to biodiversity?
 - How likely is it that GMOs will threaten biodiversity?
 - What are possible solutions?
 - Who is in charge of monitoring GMOs for possible biodiversity issues?
 - How is biodiversity measured?
 - What do experts in the field of GMOs feel about the issues around biodiversity?

USE BEAM! (BACKGROUND, EVIDENCE, ARGUMENT, METHOD)

- Do GMOs threaten biodiversity?
 - [B] How do you define GMOs?
 - [B] What does the label GMO apply to?
 - [B] Does anyone oversee/regulation GMOs?
 - [B] How do you define biodiversity?
 - [E] Has there ever been a case of GMOs harming biodiversity?
 - [A] What is the current possible risk to biodiversity?
 - [E OR A] How likely is it that GMOs will threaten biodiversity?
 - [E OR A] What are possible solutions?
 - [B] Who is in charge of monitoring GMOs for possible biodiversity issues?
 - [M] How is biodiversity measured?
 - [A] What do experts in the field of GMOs feel about the issues around biodiversity?

WHAT ABOUT THE STS FRAMEWORK?

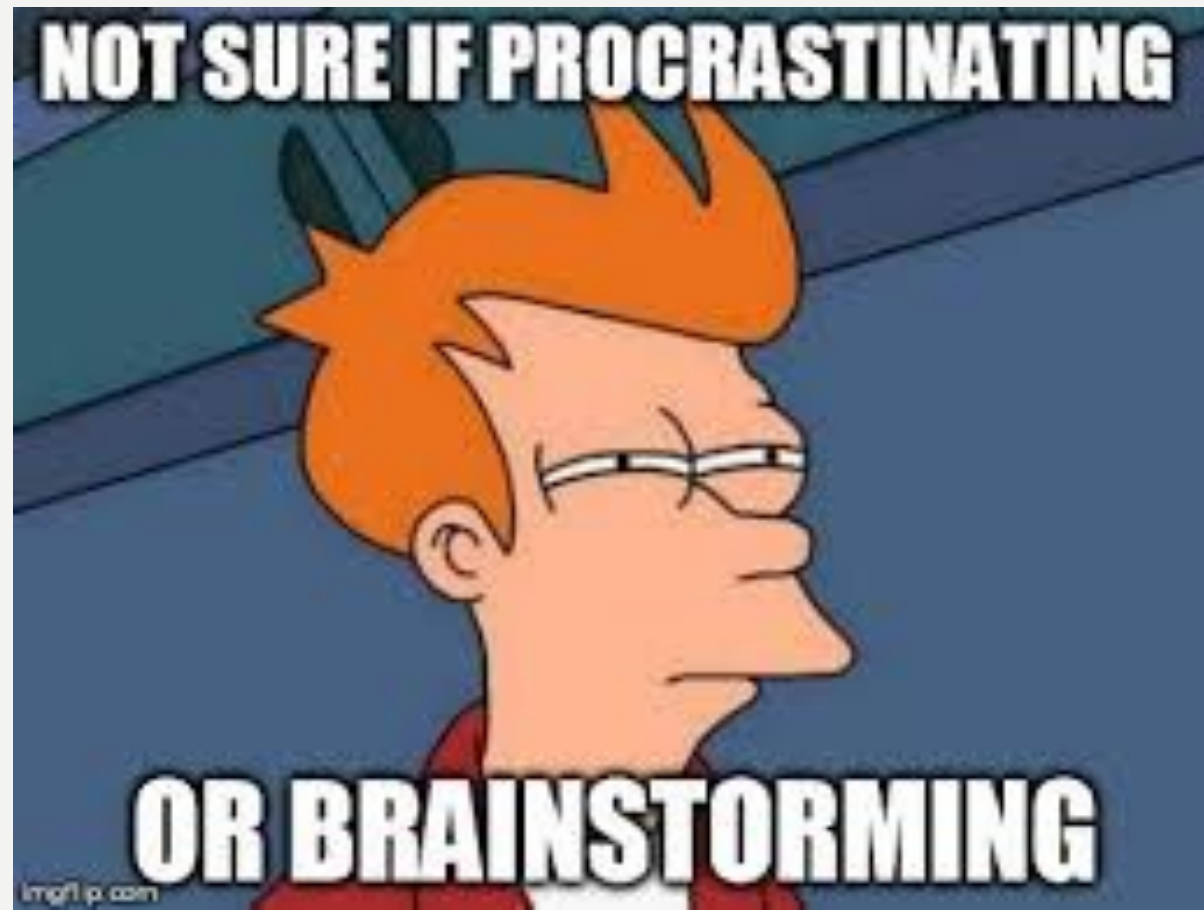
- Focus on narrowing the topic for now. There will be an STS framework that will help you answer your research question!
- You will need a *general* idea for your topic statement about how you are planning to look at your subject
 - How does the technology shape society?
 - How does society shape the technology?
 - Is there a back and forth relationship between society and technology in this case?

CITATIONS

- APA Formatting
- More resources on our Canvas site
- <http://guides.lib.virginia.edu/c.php?g=515274&p=3520705>
- <https://owl.english.purdue.edu/owl/resource/560/01/>
- <http://blog.apastyle.org/>

QUESTIONS?

- I'm here to help!



ACTIVITY!

- Whiteboard Exercise
- Step 1: Your topic!
- Step 2: Break it down – smaller questions
- Step 3: Label with BEAM
- Step 4: Who will care about it? What resources or disciplines might you turn to to research your topic?